TriAliasTB

User Guide - v1.0.6

Sort Thunderbird email aliases alphabetically without changing the order of mail accounts.

Documented version

This guide describes TriAliasTB v1.0.6. The interface is French. The program keeps the primary identity first and sorts aliases by email address.

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1. What TriAliasTB does

TriAliasTB is a Windows utility that sorts Thunderbird aliases alphabetically without changing the order of mail accounts.

- Profiles are detected from `profiles.ini`.
- The primary identity stays first.
- Aliases are sorted by email address.
- A backup of `prefs.js` is created before writing.
- Thunderbird must be closed before changes.
- The EXE runs without Python installed.

2. Before you start

Required condition
Thunderbird must be completely closed to sort aliases. TriAliasTB detects its state and enables or disables the button accordingly.

Download `TriAliasTB.exe` from the official release. Python is not required. For first use, keep Thunderbird closed while starting TriAliasTB.

3. Downloading and launching TriAliasTB

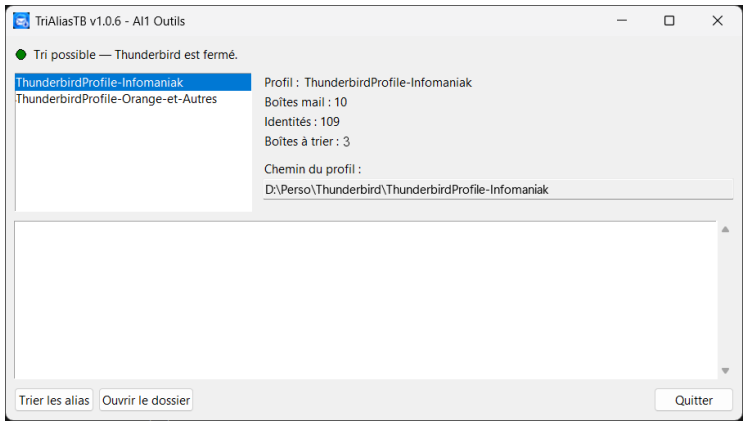
The application is distributed as a single Windows executable, `TriAliasTB.exe`.

Windows SmartScreen warning
Microsoft Defender SmartScreen may say the application is “unrecognized” on first launch because it is new and has not built a reputation. If the file came from the official release, click “More info”, then “Run anyway”.

This warning concerns the file’s reputation with SmartScreen; by itself it is not a malware diagnosis. Windows security behavior can vary.

4. First use and profile selection

At startup, TriAliasTB searches for available Thunderbird profiles. The list appears on the left. Select the profile you want to inspect.

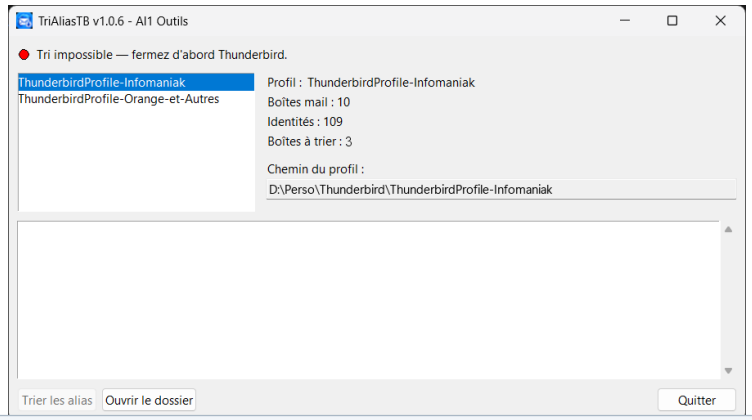


Thunderbird is closed: green indicator, sorting available.

The information area shows the profile name, number of mail accounts, total identities and accounts requiring sorting.

5. Checking the Thunderbird status

The indicator and message at the top show whether sorting is possible. The state refreshes automatically.



Red: sorting impossible — close Thunderbird first.
Green: sorting possible — Thunderbird is closed.

6. Sorting aliases

When the indicator is green and “Sort aliases” is enabled:
1. Click “Sort aliases”.
2. Confirm if prompted.
3. A backup of `prefs.js` is created.
4. Relevant identity entries are rewritten with sorted aliases.
5. Analysis runs again automatically.

The first identity of each account remains first. Additional identities are sorted by email address without changing mail-account order.

7. When there is nothing to sort

No unnecessary changes
If all accounts are already in order, TriAliasTB reports that all aliases are already sorted. No extra backup is created and no changes are made.

8. Safety, backup and portable operation

• A backup of `prefs.js` is created before writing, with a name such as `prefs.js.bak_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS`.
• Only `mail.account.accountX.identities=` lines are rewritten.
• Mail-account order is not changed.
• The app does not write to the Registry, `%APPDATA%` or `%LOCALAPPDATA%`.
• First-run settings may be saved in `TriAliasTB.ini` beside the program.

9. Quick troubleshooting

Sort button disabled.	Make sure Thunderbird is completely closed.
Profile missing.	Check its entry in `profiles.ini`.
SmartScreen appears.	Verify the official source; click “More info”, then “Run anyway” if you choose to continue.
Desktop shortcut missing.	v1.0.6 detects the actual Desktop location, even on another drive. If creation fails, the error is shown and retrying is possible on the next launch.
No changes wanted.	Close TriAliasTB without running the sort.

10. Where to find the program

GitHub : https://github.com/al1outils/TriAliasTB

v1.0.6 is functionally validated; v1.0.4 remains the latest public release until a new release is created.

11. What is new in v1.0.6

• Detects the actual Windows Desktop location, even when moved to another drive.
• Resizable window with a minimum size.
• Official icon in the interface and executable.